



DEPARTMENT OF ECONOMICS
JAHANGIRNAGAR UNIVERSITY
TUTORIAL ANSWER SCRIPT

Marks

Class Roll No. 970

Course No. 512

Tutorial No. 02

Course Title:

Signature of the invigilator:

Date: 03.02.26

ANSWER FROM HERE

Answer to the Q. No.: 01

(a)

The global demand for meat is undergoing a massive surge, driven by a combination of demographic shifts, economic prosperity and changing lifestyles. Analyst project that global meat consumption will continue to rise by over 14% by 2030 with nearly 80% of that growth occurring in

developing nations.

Here is an analysis of why the global meat demand of meat is rising -

① Demographic and Regional Shifts:

The primary engine of meat demand is the sheer increase in the number of consumers and their regional concentration.

Population Growth: With the global

population reaching 8.2 billion in 2024

and heading toward 8.7 billion by 2033,

the need for protein is higher than ever.

The Emerging Tigers of Asia: Asia alone

is expected to account for half of the global increase in poultry and pork consumption this decade.

Middle Eastern Influence: In Gulf

nations, a combination of high population growth and a "Westernization" of diets has led to a surge in red meat and poultry intake.

② The Rising of Global Middle

Class: Economic status is the strongest predictor of meat consumption.

Income Elasticity: As people move from low to middle income, meat is often the first luxury added to the diet. The upper-middle class in developing nations is buying more meat as their purchasing power increases.

Dietary Diversification: Rising disposable income allows families to shift away from starch-heavy diets toward protein-rich foods like beef and chicken.

③ Rapid Urbanization and Global Food

chains: The shift from rural farms to urban centers has fundamentally changed how and where people eat.

Urban-based development: Modern cities are designed around convenience and commercial hubs which fosters "meat-centric" dining.

The Fast Food Effect: Global chains like KFC, McDonald's and Domino's have expanded aggressively into emerging markets. These brands standardize

meat-based menus, making high-protein meals affordable and easily accessible to billions of urban dwellers.

④ Labor Trends and Processed

Food Demand: Social changes, particularly in the workforce, have reduced the time available for traditional meal preparation.

Female Participation in the labor force:

As more women enter the professional workforce globally, the time allocated to slow cooking at home has diminished.

The Convenience Revolution: This time poverty has created a massive market for processed and frozen meat-based foods and the emergence of processed food suppliers such as Kazi farms, Bengal meat in Bangladesh.

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food

(b)

Excessive buffalo production in India has led several unintended negative effects on agricultural land and overall food production. While buffaloes play an important role in India's rural economy, especially in milk production - their unchecked growth has created structural stress on land, resources and food security.

① Pressure on agricultural land: It

is a major issue. Buffaloes require

large amount of fodder, including

green grass, crop residues, & cultivated

feed crops like maize and sorghum.

To ~~met~~ meet this demand,

farmers often divert fertile agricultural

land away from food crops towards

fodder cultivation.

② Overgrazing and Land Degradation:

It has become serious concerns. In

many regions, especially in northern and

central India, buffaloes graze on common lands, riverbanks and fallow fields. Excessive grazing compacts the soil, reduces soil fertility and increases erosion. Over time, this degrades agricultural land, making it less productive and harder to restore. From a long-term perspective, this is bad economics and worse environmental management.

③ Water stress: It cannot be ignored,

Buffaloes consume significantly more

water than smaller livestock. Their

maintenance - drinking water, washing

and fodder irrigation - adds pressure

to scarce water resources. Less water

for crops means lower yields and

increased vulnerability to droughts.

④ Imbalance in Food production priorities:

A growing focus on dairy output

encourages farmers to prioritize milk

over food grains, While dairy contributes

to income, it does not replace the caloric and nutritional role of staple foods. This imbalance can push food prices up, disproportionately hurting low-income households.

⑤ Environmental externalities: Large

buffalo populations contribute to methane emissions and waste mismanagement, which indirectly affect soil and crop quality.

Moreover, while buffalo production is economically valuable, excessive and poorly managed expansion has negatively affected agricultural land and food production in India.

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excessive feed
requirement for
beef /
poultry
production

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(C)

Over the last decade, Bangladesh has experienced a notable rise in Nepia grass production, reflecting changes in livestock demand, land use and farm level decision-making. This rise can be assessed from economic, agricultural and sustainability ~~per~~ perspectives.

of the dairy and livestock

As milk production has grown

the demand for reliable and

and fodder. Napier grass offers high

yield, fast regrowth and

resilience to local climatic conditions.

It is an attractive choice for

small and medium farmers.

Agricultural standpoint: The rise in

grass production has helped

revive chronic fodder shortages.

Farmers increasingly cultivate it on fallow land, field margins and marginal plots that are unsuitable for food crops. This has improved land utilization without significantly displacing staple food production in many areas.

③ Rural livelihoods: Nepia grass has strengthened rural livelihoods. Its cultivation is labor-intensive, creating employment opportunities for women

and youth. By lowering feed costs, it improves profitability in dairy farming, indirectly contributing to rural income growth and food-system diversification.

However a critical assessment must also consider potential risks. If Napier grass cultivation expands excessively into fertile cropland, it could crowd out food crops, posing long-term food security concerns.

The rise in Nepia grass production in Bangladesh over the past decade is largely a positive development, driven by rational economic incentives and livestock sector growth.

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